Starting Simple Is Valid

Three tiers of data intensity — all produce legitimate accounts

TIER 1

Global / Literature

"No primary data"

DATA SOURCES

- Allen Coral Atlas, Global Mangrove Watch
- Sea Around Us catch reconstructions
- IPCC default emission factors
- ESVD value-transfer estimates

METHODS

- Global satellite products (unvalidated)
- Published literature values
- Benefit transfer from similar sites

✓ Valid first account

TIER 2

National / Regional

"National or regional data"

DATA SOURCES

- National land-cover maps
- Government fisheries statistics
- Regional monitoring programs
- National tourism surveys

METHODS

- Medium-resolution satellite imagery
- Field surveys (periodic)
- Local market prices

✓ Standard operational

TIER 3

Research-Grade

"Intensive primary data"

DATA SOURCES

- High-resolution satellite + drone imagery
- Permanent monitoring transects
- Vessel monitoring system (VMS) data
- Primary economic valuation studies

METHODS

- Object-based image classification
- Nested plot sampling design
- Econometric modeling (WTP, choice)

✓ Research-grade

Tier 1 → Tier 2 → Tier 3

★ A Tier 1 account published today is more useful than a Tier 3 account planned for next year.